

VertiGO!!!



Newsletter of the New Zealand Alpine Club, Wellington Section

NO. 733 OCTOBER 2010, PO BOX 1628 WELLINGTON



Climbing in Peru – image courtesy of Scott Miller

Club nights are at Turnbull House, on the first unimpeded Monday of every month. New and prospective members are welcome. Meetings and talks start at 8.00 pm with club business and tea & coffee afterwards. Meet for dinner at the Backbencher public bar at 6.30 pm and on to Turnbull House at 7.30 pm for a catch up.



Next section night: 4 October, 8pm

Over the Three Cols of Nepal by Nicky McIndoe & Blair Hiscoke



Earlier this year Nicky and Blair had five weeks in Nepal - trekking up to Makalu base camp over three high passes (two above 6,000m) and then up to Everest Base camp, without climbing any mountains. They're coming along to tell us all about it.

AGM Wrap Up

As usual the AGM was a quiet and brief affair with about 35 keen members there to exercise their democratic rights.

The good news from the meeting was that we have finally found a Chairperson after two years of absence – me! I doubt that you members will notice much change to the way things run but I'm sure the Committee will be much the happier for it. I'm also very happy to have Scott Taylor along side as Vice Chair to help me out when things get tricky.

We've also unearthed some Section rules and found out that a Patron is required. Nank humbly accepted this nomination.

Welcome to the two newbies on Committee: Lorraine Johns and Vincent Zintzen. And thanks to those stepping down: Kevin Patterson, Shichang Hou, and Jessie Bailey.

There's not much more to add from the meeting that isn't already covered in the Annual Reports so feel free to read these at www.nzalpine.wellington.net.nz/?page_id=17

We'll post the minutes to the meeting up onto the website very soon.

Many thanks and I'd better get on with then.....

James Wright
Chairperson



TRIP REPORTS

Please send your trip reports to newsletter@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz, so everyone can enjoy your stories.

Peru

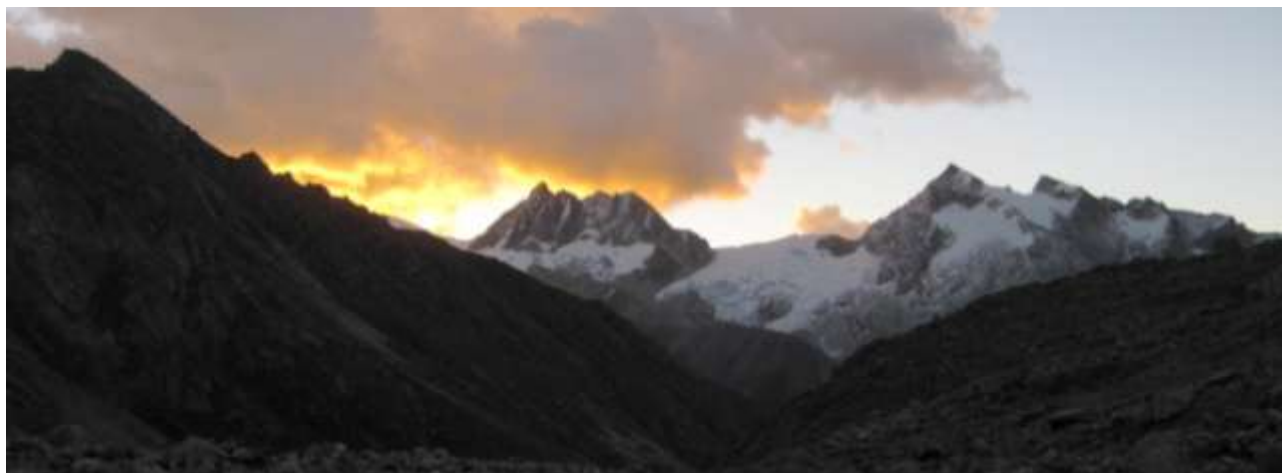
Frigid and fatigued at 5500m at 2 in the morning; the yin and the yang of high altitude climbing. The precarious balance of alpine maladies; icicles hanging from tent poles like a Central Otago frost and the body's internal coping mechanisms: an irregular respiratory pattern, a palpating heart causing sleepless nights, and ailments of unknown gastrointestinal origin. Oh to be climbing in a 3rd world country. Peru in this instance.

As a TTC AIC graduate of 2008, Peru was the opportunity to consolidate two years of alpine climbing in New Zealand and experience a path less beaten. Over the course of eight weeks in July and August 2010 I was based in the sleepy mountain town of Huaraz, Northern Peru. I attempted five mountains in the Cordilleras Blanca and Huayhuash with success summiting three of these sky piercers.

I planned the expedition with few expectations but the additional implements required of high altitude climbing in a 3rd world country and the sage Nankervis' wisdom. What eventuated was an experience of proportions commensurate to the mountains I was climbing. From humble Arrieros (donkey drivers), fluorescently cloaked women and understated adobe villages struggling to remain economically afloat, I became acquainted with receding glaciers, perfect week long stable weather windows and 60% of the oxygen available at sea level. Climbing partners acquired from gringo bars, the Casa de Guías (House of Guides), and my hostel were of varying degrees of competence and experience. Some of whom will become friends for life, and others, lessons on better climbing partner selection.

However, the real highlights were in the daily living routines: shopping for climbing meals in the open air markets, drinking the juice of 12 oranges manually squeezed for NZ50c, avoiding man-swallowing holes in the footpaths, and sharing stories of the hills with local people over local food. The perfect way to purposefully explore the path less beaten.

Scott Miller





UPCOMING CLUB TRIPS



Wellington Section Trips

Trips are a key part of the Wellington Section. Trips can be of any length, any level of difficulty, and any size. Simply email us or approach us at the monthly meeting, and we can help you get going. Send your trip ideas, no matter how vague, to trips@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz



Mt Taranaki / Egmont

Date: 10 – 12 September 2010

Coordinator: Richard Davidson

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

On Friday night we will drive up to Taranaki and walk in for 2h to Tahurangi Lodge. Saturday we will ascend to the crater and then summit of Taranaki. Those who are especially adventurous might like to have a go at Sharks Tooth. Sunday may involve a jaunt to Humpries Castle or the Organ Pipes for a bit of rock climbing. Contact Richard at 027 427 3467 or email richard.davidson@chapmantripp.com





Mt Manukau and Te Ao Whekere – Seaward Kaikouras

Date: 22 – 26 October 2010

Coordinator: Alex Berryman

Level: Level = AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Spring snow trip to end the northern alpine season! Come on this challenging 3 day climb in the Seaward Kaikouras. On Friday night we'll take the ferry and stay near the road end. Saturday will be the trip in up to a basin below Te Ao Whekere where we'll tent overnight. On Sunday we'll summit TAW and traverse along to Manakau then drop down to a ridge where we'll again tent overnight. On Monday we'll walk out down the Hapuku River. Keeping one spare day in reserve for weather. No ropes required. Contact Alex Berryman 021 0233 7545 or email at alexander_berryman@yahoo.co.nz



Tasman Saddle

Date: 19 – 28 November 2010

Coordinator: Rob Hawes

Level: AIC Graduate and 0-3 years experience

Set aside space in your leave calendar for this one! This will be a week long trip into the Mt Cook NP glacier zone. Multiple peaks abound within easy distance of Tasman Saddle Hut including Mt Green, Elie de Beaumont, and the infamous Hochstetter Dome. On Friday night we'll fly down to Christchurch and drive to Mt Cook village, staying in Unwin Hut. On Saturday we will fly in to Tasman Saddle by ski plane and spend the following 8 days climbing. Or whatever. Sunday lunchtime we fly back out, and then drive back to Christchurch to catch our plane home. Contact Rob Hawes, ph 0274 470461 or 528 3692 (h) or RobertH@tfg.co.nz



Upper Tasman Glacier



Mt Taranaki / Egmont (again)

Date: 26 – 28 November 2010

Coordinator: Steve Minchin

Level: trad climbing grade 18+

Do you enjoy climbing a stone's throw from the road end? Do you like clipping bolts? Do like to belay whilst sitting under a tree, listening to the gentle burbling of a forest stream, and contemplating the fantails frolicking? If you answered "yes" to any of these questions, this trip might not be for you... If, however, you want to lug your kit halfway up a mountain, plug your own pro, and enjoy a bracing mountain wind then Mt Taranaki will float your boat. This is a great opportunity to get off the beaten track and climb some of the North Island's least frequented trad routes on some top quality rock. We'll be heading up on Thursday night to make the drive worthwhile and will be staying at the Taranaki Alpine Club's lodge on the mountain (one hour walk in, \$20 / night). The crag is all natural pro, and reports are that the pick of the routes are graded 18+. Dust off your nuts and come join the fun. Contact Steve at stevem@solutionz.co.nz for further info or to sign up.



Broken River, Arthur's Pass

Date: 2 – 9 January 2011

This years Climbing Camp will be in the Broken River Ski Area from Sunday 2nd January to Sunday 9th January 2011. It will be hosted by the Caterbury/Westland Section and is a fantastic opportunity for climbers and their families to gather in the mountains for climbing, tramping and generally have fun. There is some fantastic climbing in the area; Rolleston, Murchison for Alpine climbers, Castle Hill and Quantun field for rock climbers. Plus lots of tramping opportunities too.

See NZAC website for details <http://alpineclub.org.nz/default/377>). Contact Kevin at 934 0975 (evenings) or email me at kp@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz for carpooling arrangements.



CLASSIFIEDS



Boots

SCARPA Cumbre size 41 summer and winter mountaineering boots - almost new. Also LA SPORTIVA Trango S EVO yellow size 42, UK 8, USA male 9 / female 10. New, not yet been climbed in. Contact jeanjeani@gmail.com or 021-0488-698.



NOTICES



Congratulations – six month membership extension winner

The first winner of our free 6-month membership extension is Australian Club member, Simon Locke. Congratulations to Simon, a member of 6 years standing, we value your continued support of our Club.

Members are reminded that this is an ongoing prize offer and the October renewals are coming up. To be in with a chance to win this prize, please get your renewals paid within the first two weeks of October.



CMC NZ Mountaineer of the Year

Nominations are open for the 2010 CMC NZ Mountaineer of the Year. The criteria are as follows:

1. A sustained period of hard climbing both in NZ and overseas
2. A significant ascent/new route in the calendar year - 2010
3. Contribution to climbing community in NZ ie route development, rebolting crags, running courses, writing guidebooks, work with clubs etc.

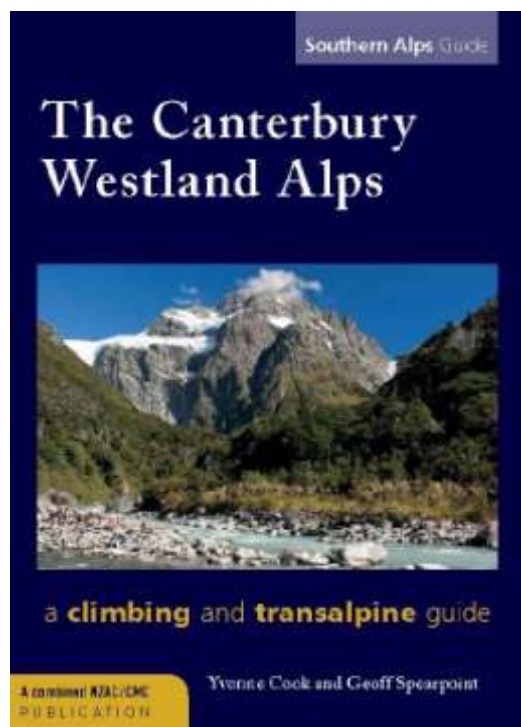
If you would like to nominate somebody, then please email moylen9@yahoo.com

This award is normally presented in February the following year i.e. 2011. Nominations will close at the end of November 2010.

Nick Moyle
President, Canterbury Mountaineering Club



Canterbury Westland Alps guidebook



The long-awaited 'The Canterbury Westland Alps' guidebook is due to be printed very soon and released for sale in about a month's time. We are going to take backorders to speed up delivery when the guide becomes available, as it will be a busy time for us with the 2011 NZAC Alpine Calendar coming out around the same time.

Here's some information on the new guide:

<https://alpineclub.org.nz/product/the-canterbury-westland-alps>

Members price \$25 (non members \$35), plus the usual for postage within NZ of \$4 first copy and \$2 per copy thereafter. Please send payment with your order. Overseas orders, please ask for a p&p quote as overseas postage will be going up October 1st and NZ Post haven't given us the new rates yet.

Payment can be made with Visa or MasterCard, or if within NZ you can send a cheque, or pay with internet banking 03 0502 0607822 00 (sorry only Visa / MasterCard accepted for overseas payments).



Travel insurance - hunting feedback

After two recent requests from members applying for travel insurance that included hunting overseas, we would like to ask for some feedback on this activity. As it is not currently covered under the travel insurance policy, the insurer has asked us to contact members for more information, so that they can look at the possibility of having cover for it available in the future.

"If we could get the number of members who have current hunting / gun licenses to provide some data around the number of trips they took that included hunting and what type of hunting was carried out this would be useful."

Please let me know if you have participated in hunting overseas (even if you found cover with another insurer), or intend to in the future, by emailing Margaret@alpineclub.org.nz



Shed 6 Queens Wharf
Wellingtons Waterfront
Ph 04 4998898 Fax 04 4998896
wn@fergskayaks.co.nz
www.fergskayaks.co.nz

Open 7 Days

Largest Real Rock Indoor Rock Wall – Kayaking – Inline Skates - Retail - Rental

Alpine Club members can climb any time for \$10
Monday nights show your Alpine Club card and climb for \$8

Do you remember
the rush of a new route?

Better routes
Less Crowds
Friendly Atmosphere
Better Bouldering

Did I mention better routes?
Least importantly: \$10 everynight, \$8 Monday for NZAC
We are the community Climbing Gym

Come to HangDog!



**HangDog Rock Climbing
Adventures**

453 Hutt Rd
Lower Hutt
(04) 589 9181
www.hangdog.co.nz
info@hangdog.co.nz

i climb.co.nz



\$255



\$295



\$360



\$360



\$230

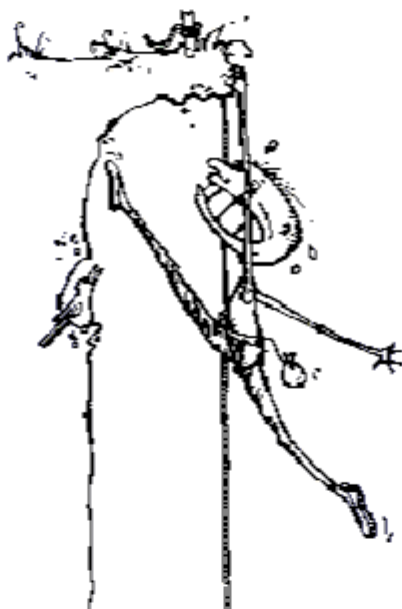


\$370



WELLINGTON SECTION: 2011/12 CONTACT LIST

Position	Name	Email alias*	Phone
Chairperson	James Wright	chairperson	027 472 5561
Vice Chair	Scott Taylor	vicechair	
Secretary	Catherine Moger	secretary or CM2	04 973 1307 (h) 021 079 0854
Treasurer	Matt Knarston	treasurer	
National Rep	James Wright	JW	027 472 5561
Instruction Convenor	Don French	DF	
Trips	Hinrich Schaefer	Trips	
Other Committee Members	Richard Davies	RD	
	Matt Knarston	MK	
	Steve Minchin	SM	
	Lorraine Johns	LJ	
	Hinrich Schaefer	HS	
	Rebecca Thomson	RT	
	Vincent Zintzen	VZ	
Other Roles:			
Gear	Marcus Manning	gear	
Personal Locator Beacons	Hinrich Schaefer	PLB	
Instruction - AIC	Don French	AIC or DF	06 3777 117 (h) 027 445 2980
Instruction - Rock	Blair Hiscoke	summerrock or BH	
Library	Derek Richardson	library	
	Peter Shanahan	PS2	
Newsletter Editor	Steve Minchin	newsletter or SM	
Rock Drill overseer	Kristen Foley	drill or KF	
Website	Richard Thomson	webmaster	
* Email address is: alias@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz eg. secretary@nzalpine.wellington.net.nz			
Any membership, Distaghil Sar Fund, or general queries should be directed to the secretary			
Any media queries should be directed to:			
National Executive Officer	Ollie Clifton	ollie@alpineclub.org.nz	03 3777 595



If undelivered please return to:

NZAC Wellington Section
PO Box 1628
Wellington

